

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1133

By Lamberth

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Edgar "Ed" Joines Cochran of Englewood.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Edgar "Ed" Joines Cochran of Englewood; and

WHEREAS, Ed Cochran was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born on October 31, 1943, Mr. Cochran was the son of Hubert Cochran and Zeola Stiles Cochran in Englewood, where he was raised in a home with eight siblings; and

WHEREAS, Ed Cochran began working at Bain and Holden Tire Company at the age of eleven and continued there throughout his teenage years and into early adulthood; he graduated from Englewood High School in 1963 and later worked for B.F. Goodrich and J.M. Huber before starting his own business; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Cochran met the love of his life, Nancy Gentry, after she challenged him to a drag race on Etowah's Tennessee Avenue in the summer of 1967; while the winner of the race is debated to this day, the two were engaged within six weeks, married in six months, and never looked back; and

WHEREAS, over the next fifty-eight years, they started and ran a successful business, managed a small family farm, raised four children, and lovingly spoiled four grandchildren; and

WHEREAS, perhaps best known as a local business owner in Englewood, Ed Cochran managed Ed's Grocery for thirty-five years from 1970 to 2005; for more than twenty of those years, his was the only grocery store in town; and

WHEREAS, with his white butcher's apron tied neatly around his waist, Mr. Cochran could be found Monday through Saturday serving the people in the town he loved; and

WHEREAS, for him, the grocery store was more than a business—it was a ministry through which he showed the love of God to others, and it was his mission that no one in Englewood go hungry; and

WHEREAS, accompanying Ed Cochran's passion for the grocery business was his love of farming, but more specifically, his love of farming atop Chestnut Ridge in Nonaburg, a location where he had longed to live since childhood and described as "the prettiest place on Earth"; and

WHEREAS, over a number of decades, Mr. Cochran worked tirelessly to fulfill his dream of building back his family's farm, and he even took the dream a little further by expanding it with his children and beloved grandchildren; and

WHEREAS, though faced with his fair share of trials and adversity, Ed Cochran lived a life overwhelmingly defined by God's blessings—a loving wife of nearly six decades, four children who adored him, and four grandchildren who were his absolute pride and joy; most importantly, Mr. Cochran knew Jesus, which means his story does not end on this Earth and his legacy continues; and

WHEREAS, he will be sadly mourned but fondly remembered by his wife, Nancy Cochran; children, Kim (Todd) Cochran-Graham, Mike Cochran, Karen (Justin) Baker, and State Representative Mark Cochran; grandchildren, Melia Baker, Kellan Baker, McCain Baker, and Reagan Baker; siblings, Huberta Williams, Twila Chrisman, Dorcas Carter, Jean McDermott, June Cochran, and Doug Cochran; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his parents, Ed Cochran was preceded in death by his siblings, DeLayne Cochran and Gail Anderson; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Cochran leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Edgar "Ed" Joines Cochran, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we extend our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Cochran.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.